

Phongsakon Mark Konrad

Curriculum Vitae

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Summary

I work on the foundations of how models learn, in particular on when learning recovers the world's real causal structure and when it only imitates it. My bachelor's was broad and curiosity-driven, across remote sensing, medical imaging, agentic software, and the internals of language models, and the same problem kept surfacing: models break where they only imitate structure instead of recovering it. I work phenomenon first, building small settings with known causal ground truth, with counterfactual reasoning as my main test. At SDU's Data and Intelligence Lab I started as a research assistant and grew into leading my own projects with Serkan Ayvaz. I graduated from SDU in June 2026 and begin the MPhil in Machine Learning and Machine Intelligence at the University of Cambridge this October, to build the theoretical foundation for a PhD, after an unconventional path through military service, startups, and a semester at HKUST.

Research Interests

Foundations of deep learning, representation learning, causal representation learning, identifiability, counterfactual reasoning, learning dynamics, and the theory of learning.

Education

2026– **MPhil, Machine Learning and Machine Intelligence**, *University of Cambridge*, Cambridge, UK, admitted, begins Oct 2026

2025 **Exchange Semester, Computer Science & Engineering**, *HKUST*, Hong Kong SAR
Specialisation courses in Machine Learning (COMP4211), Deep Learning in Computer Vision (COMP4471), Large Language Models (COMP4901B), and Reinforcement Learning (COMP4901Z), plus the postgraduate Data Visualisation (COMP6411D).

2023–2026 **BSc in Engineering (Software Engineering)**, *University of Southern Denmark*, Sønderborg, DK, GPA 10.7/12 ($\approx 3.8/4.0$)
Graduated June 2026. BSc thesis with T. L. Adam, *Heimdall: Only the Safe Shall Pass*, a conformal verifier between autonomous bidders and the Nordic balancing market, with code and model weights released.

Selected Publications

- 2026 **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanyel, S. Ayvaz. *Self-Reports Do Not Identify Self-Models: An Identifiability Test for Counterfactual Reports*. Accepted (oral), *PhilML Workshop, ICML 2026*. [PDF]
In short. Self-reports are evidence about behaviour in a prompt, not proof of a self-model. Wrong-source demonstrations pull affect-state reports toward the source family unless mechanism binding holds.
- 2026 **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanyel, S. Ayvaz. *Decoded but Unused: Instruction Tuning Routes Moral Framing into the Judgment Readout*. Accepted (poster), *ICML 2026 Workshop on Mechanistic Interpretability*. [OpenReview]
In short. Moral framing is linearly decodable in pretrained models but only causally routed to judgment after instruction tuning.
- 2026 **P. M. Konrad**, T. L. Adam, S. Ayvaz. *Coverage Debt: Pricing the Conformal Coverage Gap Through a Real Electricity-Market Redesign*. Preprint. [PDF]
In short. When a real balancing-market redesign expands price volatility, distribution-free intervals under-cover in step, and a certified worst-case loss limit is breached at the same rate the intervals miss. We call this coverage debt, show it repays under refreshed calibration, and release an eight-zone European benchmark with non-reforming controls.

Research Experience

Jan 2026– **Research Collaborator**, *HKUST DataVISards group*, Hong Kong SAR
Machine learning and data-visualisation research.

Jan 2026– **Research Collaborator**, *SDU Data & Intelligence Lab*, Sønderborg, DK
Over time I moved from supporting the group's projects to formulating and leading my own, running them end to end from problem formulation and experimental design through engineering, manuscript writing, and venue selection. I co-author with Assoc. Prof. Serkan Ayvaz across interpretability, NLP, medical imaging, and remote sensing.

Sep 2024–Dec 2025 **Research Assistant**, *SDU Data & Intelligence Lab*, Sønderborg, DK
Joined the group building ML pipelines end to end and contributing to study design, literature reviews, model development, and manuscript preparation. Supported grant proposals and multimodal dataset management.

Full Publication List

Peer-reviewed and accepted

Interpretability and safety (workshop)

1. **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanel, S. Ayvaz (2026). *Self-Reports Do Not Identify Self-Models: An Identifiability Test for Counterfactual Reports*. Accepted (oral), *PhilML Workshop, ICML 2026*. [PDF]
2. **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanel, S. Ayvaz (2026). *Decoded but Unused: Instruction Tuning Routes Moral Framing into the Judgment Readout*. Accepted (poster), *ICML 2026 Workshop on Mechanistic Interpretability*. [OpenReview]
3. **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanel, S. Ayvaz (2026). *A Path Already Walked: On Inheriting Network-Neuroscience Tools for Mechanistic Interpretability*. Accepted (virtual poster), *ICML 2026 Workshop on Mechanistic Interpretability*. [OpenReview]

AI for software engineering (workshop)

4. **P. M. Konrad**, T. L. Adam, R. Terrenzi, S. Ayvaz (2026). *Architecture Without Architects: How AI Coding Agents Shape Software Architecture*. Accepted, *SAGAI Workshop, IEEE ICSA 2026*. arXiv:2604.04990
5. T. L. Adam, **P. M. Konrad**, R. Terrenzi, F. G. Lukas, R. Yilmaz, K. Sierszecki, S. Ayvaz (2026). *CAKE: Cloud Architecture Knowledge Evaluation of Large Language Models*. Accepted, *KDA-AI Workshop, IEEE ICSA 2026*. arXiv:2604.05755
6. R. Terrenzi, **P. M. Konrad**, T. L. Adam, S. Ayvaz (2026). *A Reference Architecture for Agentic Hybrid Retrieval in Dataset Search*. Accepted, *SAML Workshop, IEEE ICSA 2026*. arXiv:2604.16394

Conference proceedings

7. **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanel, S. Ayvaz (2025). *Beyond Major Floods: Deep Learning for Detecting Shallow Water Inundation in Agricultural Areas*. *KES 2025, Procedia Computer Science*, 270, 301–310. [open access]

Preprints and works in progress

Interpretability and safety

8. **P. M. Konrad**, T. Tanel, S. Ayvaz (2026). *Acceptance Cards: A Four-Diagnostic Standard for Safe Fine-Tuning Defense Claims*. Preprint. arXiv:2605.10575
9. **P. M. Konrad**, T. L. Adam, A. C. H. Merrild, R. de Rosa, R. Terrenzi, T. Tanel, S. Ayvaz (2026). *The Open-Box Fallacy: Why AI Deployment Needs a Calibrated Verification Regime*. Preprint. arXiv:2605.10601
10. **P. M. Konrad**, T. L. Adam, S. Ayvaz (2026). *Coverage Debt: Pricing the Conformal Coverage Gap Through a Real Electricity-Market Redesign*. Preprint. [PDF]

Applied ML and other

11. **P. M. Konrad**, A.-A. Popa, Y. Sabzehmeidani, L. Zhong, M. Tripathy, A. Constantinescu, E. A. Liehn, S. Ayvaz (2025). *Challenges in Deep Learning-Based Small Organ Segmentation: A Benchmarking Perspective for Medical Research with Limited Datasets*. Preprint. arXiv:2509.05892
12. **P. M. Konrad**, C. H. Kunstmann-Olsen, J. Fiutowski, S. Ayvaz (2026). *How Much of Non-Destructive Fruit-Ripeness Assessment Is Real? A Confound-Controlled, Low-Cost Visible Hyperspectral Study Across Five Fruit*. Preprint. [PDF]

Teaching

2026 **Teaching Assistant, Artificial Intelligence (BSc)**, *University of Southern Denmark*
Lead exercise sessions and student supervision, and design hands-on lab assignments. Built an interactive AI course with step-by-step animations, used as supplementary material.

Invited Talks

- 2026 **Agentic Engineering in Practice**, House of Software Sønderborg (inaugural event). Invited to introduce agent skills, the Model Context Protocol, and plugin-based development to an audience of 100+ software engineers, engineering leaders, and founders.

Academic Service

- 2025– **Student Member**, Educational Committee, Software Engineering Programme, SDU. Represent students in curriculum and quality assurance discussions on course content, assessment, and study environment.

Honors and Awards

- 2026 **Best thesis, Software Engineering programme** (≈ 100 students), University of Southern Denmark. Nominated on that basis for the faculty-wide Faculty of Engineering (TEK) Best Thesis Award.
- 2026 **William Demant Fonden Grant** supporting graduate study.
- 2026 **Nominated, Best Startup Award** for DreamBear (SaturoLabs).
- 2024, 2025 **Top 10**, Danish National Championship in AI (DM i AI), competing solo against 50+ teams.
- 2023 **1st place**, SDU Case Competition (48-hour sustainability challenge, Danfoss and Linak cases).
- 2021 **Formal Recognition for Exemplary Service**, Bundeswehr, for setting a benchmark in dedication and professionalism.
- 2021 **Performance Bonus for Outstanding Achievement**, Bundeswehr, for sustained excellence and independent handling of complex tasks.

Professional Experience

- 2026– **Founder**, *SaturoLabs*, Denmark
Products at the intersection of AI and software engineering. Live products include *claudboyz.com*, *getproofz.com*, and *dreambear.app*.
- 2024 **CTO & Co-Founder**, *Tutora ApS*, Sønderborg, DK
Led development of the company's web application from end to end.
- 2022–2024 **Co-CEO & Co-Founder**, *Yeager GmbH*, Remote
Built *stabil.ai*, an AI powerlifting training app with personalised plans via MRV and MEV and real-time feedback.
- 2017–2021 **Staff Duty Soldier**, *Bundeswehr (German Armed Forces)*, Glücksburg, DE
Led a small HR team administering 600+ soldiers. Twice decorated.

Technical Skills

- Languages Python, JavaScript, SQL
- ML PyTorch, Hugging Face, TransformerLens, scikit-learn, pandas, NumPy, Optuna, Weights & Biases
- Tooling Git, Docker, Google Cloud Platform, React, React Native, Node.js

Languages

- Fluent English (professional), German (native), Thai (native)
- Basic Danish